Put the Observer App on Your Phone

About 2 minutes. Nothing to download. Nothing to pay for.

There is nothing to download.

We call it "the app," but it is really a **website**. You open it in the same program you use to look things up on the internet (Safari, Chrome, or Samsung Internet).

To make it feel like an app, you put a **shortcut icon on your home screen**. After that, you tap the icon and it opens, just like any other app.

You will not find it in the App Store or Google Play. If you see something there with a similar name, it is not ours. Do not install it.

First: open the website

Tap this address, or type it exactly into the **address bar** of your web browser:

web-trainstorm.onrender.com

The address bar is the long box at the top (or bottom) of the browser that shows the current web address. Typing it into a Google search box also works. Just tap the result that shows this exact address.

⏳ The first time, it can take up to a minute to appear.

If nobody has used it for a while, the website has to "wake up." A blank or loading screen for 30–60 seconds is normal. **Wait. Don't keep tapping.** After it wakes up, it's fast.

Did you tap a link in a text, email, or Facebook?

Sometimes the website opens *inside* that other app instead of your real browser. If so, you won't see the "Add to Home Screen" choice.

Fix: look for a button that says **Open in Safari**, **Open in Chrome**, or **Open in browser** (often behind ⋯ or ⋮). Or just type the address into your browser yourself.

Next: pick your phone

Not sure which you have? An **iPhone** has an Apple logo on the back. Almost every other phone (Samsung, Google Pixel, Motorola, and others) is an **Android**.

🍎 iPhone or iPad, using Safari most iPhones

🍎 iPhone, using Chrome, Edge, or Firefox

🤖 Android, using Chrome Pixel, Motorola, most Androids

🤖 Samsung phone, using Samsung Internet

🤖 Android, using Firefox or Edge

💻 Computer (Windows or Mac)

Most observing happens on a phone, but a computer is handy for reading the training.

1. Open the website in your browser (Chrome, Edge, Safari, or Firefox).
2. Save it as a bookmark: press **Ctrl + D** on Windows, or ⌘ **Command + D** on a Mac. (Or click the ☆ star at the right end of the address bar.)
3. Click **Done**. Next time, find it in your bookmarks or just start typing "web-trainstorm" in the address bar.

Keep your notes safe

Your observations are saved on your phone until you tap "Submit to team." Until then, they live only inside the browser you used. Four rules:

1. **Always open it the same way**, from your home-screen icon. On an iPhone, the icon and Safari keep *separate* notes. Something you logged in Safari will not show up in the icon, and the reverse.
2. **Don't use Private or Incognito browsing.** Everything is erased when you close it.

3. **Submit before you clean up.** Don't clear your browsing history, "website data," or cookies, and don't delete the home-screen icon, while you have unsent observations.
4. **Submit at the end of every shift**, even if you plan to come back.

Already logged things in the browser before you made the icon? Open the browser the old way one more time, tap **Submit to team**, and confirm it went through. Then switch to the icon for good. Codes you entered on the Setup tab may need to be typed again in the icon.

If something doesn't look right

What you see	What to do
Can't find it in the App Store or Play Store	That's expected. It isn't there. Go back to "First: open the website."
No "Add to Home Screen" choice anywhere	You're probably inside another app (text, email, Facebook). Open it in your real browser. Also check you are not in Private/Incognito mode.
Blank white or dark screen	It's waking up. Wait a full minute before trying again.
"Page not found" or a search results page	The address was typed slightly wrong. Check spelling: **web-trainstorm.onrender.com** (there's a dash after "web").
I added it, but I can't find the icon	**iPhone:** swipe left through your home screens, or swipe down from the middle of the screen and type the name. **Android:** check the last home screen page, or your app list.
My old notes are gone	You may have opened it a different way (icon vs. browser). Try the other one. **Don't delete anything**, and call the hotline or your team lead.
The icon is a tiny picture of the page, not a logo	That's normal. It still works.

Helping someone else set up?

- Have them open it in their **real** browser, not from a text-message preview.
- Make the icon **before** they log anything.
- Have them close the browser tab and open the icon once, so they know where it lives.

Observer support hotline (text or call): (608) 699-6950
Phone menus change with updates. If your screen looks a little different, look for the same words: *Share*, *Add to Home Screen*, *Create shortcut*, or *Add page to*.